





ART OF CONTRAST

How a seamless dance of raw stone and cascading ceramic finds itself inside a striking glass pavilion

By **RIDHI KALE**

Forget predictable red lanterns and design clichés, at The Oberoi Gurgaon's stunning new outpost, Madam Chow, Studio Lotus is serving pure spatial drama with a side of high sophistication. Nestled within a sun-drenched glass pavilion overlooking the iconic reflective pool, the restaurant avoids superficial tropes, choosing instead an elegant game of material hide-and-seek. Behind this brilliant dance of light and shadow is Asha Sairam, principal at Studio Lotus. "Our overarching design intent was to use the idea of eastern philosophy of duality to shape the space through a series of material and spatial contrasts. The openness of the glass pavilion is balanced by darker, more intimate areas; raw stone sits against fine woodgrain; and delicate ceramic and embroidered installations soften the architecture." By weaving handcrafted imperfection directly into the pavilion's contemporary bones, Sairam ensures that the soul of ancient tradition breathes seamlessly through the architecture.